Jihye Lee, Ph.D.

Senior Researcher, Seoul National University
Seoul, South Korea | +82-10-6608-7665 | jihyelee.123@snu.ac.kr
ORCID : 0009-0000-3183-1294 | Scopus Author ID: 59182388500

Academic and Research Appointments

Senior Researcher, Seoul, South Korea
Visual Arts Institute, Seoul National University **Oct 2025–Present**

- Serve as one of three senior researchers leading the older adult–robot interaction workstream in a six-year, KRW 3.0 billion national program on multi-agent social robot systems.
- Design and evaluate home-based social robots that support older adults' meaningful engagement, social connection, and autonomy.
- Mentor six master's and doctoral students in study design, field research, and quantitative analysis.

Adjunct Researcher, Gwangju, South Korea
AIX School, Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology **Oct 2025–Present**

- Investigate social and cultural bias in large language models through benchmark-based evaluation across 3,349 items, testing whether models conform differently to in-group and out-group users.
- Mentor seven master's and doctoral students in research design, computational analysis, and academic writing.

Researcher and Lead Project Coordinator, Gwangju, South Korea
AIX School, Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology **Feb 2024–Sep 2025**

- Coordinated an AI-based analysis platform translating international news into evidence for national policymaking.

Education

Chonnam National University Gwangju, South Korea
Ph.D. in Communication **2020–2024**
Thesis: Research on the Interaction and Communication Characteristics between Social Robots and Older Adults: Can Social Robots Reduce the Loneliness of Older Adults?

Chung-Ang University Seoul, South Korea
M.S. in Arts and Cultural Management **2016–2018**

Thesis: Strategy and Competitiveness of Webtoon Platforms: Centered on the Leading Platforms in Korea

Chonnam National University Gwangju, South Korea
B.A. in Communication **2012–2015**

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Peer-Reviewed Conference Papers

Bransky, K., Sweetser, P., Holthaus, P., Laban, G., Winkle, K., Akalin, N., Ashok, A., **Lee, J.**, et al. (2026). Designing Artificial Identity: The Identity Design Framework and Research Agenda. *Proceedings of the ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '26).* **CORE A**

Journal Articles

Lee, J., Park, J., Kim, Y., & Kong, D. (2026). Channel Allocation and Equity in Preventive Campaigns for Older Adults: Agent-Based Modeling Study. *Journal of Medical Internet Research*, e88429. **SCIE · Q1**

Lee, J., & Joo, C. (2025). Can Social Robots Reduce the Loneliness of Older Adults? Interaction and Communication between Social Robots and Older Adults. *Geriatric Nursing, 64*, 103359. **SCIE/SSCI · Q1**

Joo, C., & **Lee, J.** (2024). Identifying AI Ethical Issues in the Media Content Sector through the Analysis of AI Ethics Policies of Media Content Companies. *Broadcasting & Communication, 25(3)*, 5–43. **in Korean**

Yang, H., & **Lee, J.** (2023). The Impact of Encountering Hate Speech toward Jeolla-do on the Reinforcement of Stereotypes of Jeolla-do and the Use of Hate Speech. *Locality & Communication, 27(1)*, 34–65. **in Korean**

Lee, J., & Joo, C. (2022). A Study on the Perception of Self-Identity of Metaverse Users. *Korean Journal of Journalism & Communication Studies, 66(3)*, 92–138. **in Korean; KCI Excellent**

Lee, J., & Limb, S. (2018). A Study on Strategies of Korean Webtoon Platforms. *Journal of Arts Management and Policy, 47*, 31–63. **in Korean**

Manuscripts Under Review and In Preparation

Under Review

Kim, D., **Lee, J.**, et al. Ingroup Sycophancy in Large Language Models: Relational Alignment Bias under Minimal Group Conditions. *Manuscript submitted to the 41st Annual AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI-27).*

Lee, J., Kim, J., & Kim, Y. Trust and Self-Disclosure in AI Counseling. *Manuscript submitted to the International Journal of Human–Computer Interaction.*

In Preparation

Lee, J., Han, J., Kim, Y., & Yoon, S. Designing Relationship-Supportive Social Robots Through Network-Based Clustering of Older Adults.

Lee, J., Kim, Y., Yoon, S., & Han, J. Identifying Optimal Intervention Timing for Social Robots Through Ecological Momentary Assessment of Older Adults' Social Networks.

Lee, J., Bransky, K., Sweetser, P., Holthaus, P., et al. Toward Minimum Reporting Standards for Artificial Identity and Persona in Human–AI Interaction: A Systematic Review.

Lee, J., & Kim, H. When Poverty Does Not Lead to Despair: Protective Factors Against Suicidal Ideation Among Economically Disadvantaged Older Adults in a Five-Wave National Panel Study.

Conference Presentations and Workshops

Conference Presentations

Lee, J., Park, J., Kim, Y., & Kong, D. *Channel Allocation and Equity in Preventive Campaigns for Older Adults: Agent-Based Modeling Study.* Accepted for oral presentation at the AMIA 2026 Annual Symposium, Dallas, Texas, November 2026.

Lee, J., Park, J., Kim, Y., & Kong, D. *Channel Allocation and Equity in Preventive Campaigns for Older Adults: Agent-Based Modeling Study.* Paper presented at ACM Interactive Health 2026.

Lee, J., Kim, H., Park, G., Oh, S., & Jung, E. *Typology of Older Adults' Social Networks and Exploration of Social Robot Intervention Strategies.* Paper presented at the 5th World Conference on Humanities and Social Sciences, July 2026.

Lee, J., Park, J., Kim, Y., & Kong, D. *Channel Allocation and Equity in Preventive Campaigns for Older Adults: Agent-Based Modeling Study.* Paper presented at the Spring Conference of the Korean Association for Policy Analysis and Evaluation, April 2026.

Lee, J., & Joo, C. *A Study on the Perception of Self-Identity of Metaverse Users.* Paper presented at the Korean Association for Qualitative Research Conference, Seoul, South Korea, 2023.

Lee, J., & Yang, H. *The Impact of Encountering Hate Speech toward Jeolla-do on the Reinforcement of Stereotypes of Jeolla-do and the Use of Hate Speech.* Paper presented at the Korean Association for Communication and Information Studies Conference, Asan, South Korea, 2022.

Workshop Presentations, Panels and Organization

Co-organizer, *Emotions after Movement: Mechanical Motion and the Generation of Affect*, HCI Korea 2026, January 2026.

Lee, J. *Who Hears My Secrets? Self-Disclosure in Text, Voice, and Robotic AI Counseling.* Workshop presentation at the *Envisioning the Future of Interactive Health* workshop, ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2025), Yokohama, Japan, 2025.

Lee, J. *A Study on the Categorization of Media and Distancing Participants.* Panel presentation at the Korean Regional Communication Research Association Conference, Changwon, South Korea, 2022.

Research Funding and Fellowships

Sponsored Research Projects

Design of a Multi-Agent Responsive Interaction System for Expanding Social Networks
Seoul National University · Senior Researcher · PI: Eui-chul Jung **2025–2031**
Total project budget: KRW 3.0 billion (approx. USD 2.0 million)

Interdisciplinary Cultural Virtual Studio for Implementing an AI-Based Metaverse
Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology (GIST) · Researcher · PI: Duk-Jo Kong **2024–2026**
Total project budget: KRW 2.76 billion (approx. USD 1.84 million)

Development of AI-Based Safety Technologies for Hyperconnected Mobility
Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology (GIST) · Researcher · PI: Duk-Jo Kong **2024–2026**
Total project budget: KRW 3.57 billion (approx. USD 2.38 million)

Building and Operating an AI-Based Foreign News Big Data Analysis Platform
Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology (GIST) · Researcher · PI: Duk-Jo Kong **2024–2026**
Total project budget: KRW 3.9 billion (approx. USD 2.6 million)

Individual Research Grants and Fellowships

AI Cultural Content Specialized Research Grant,

Glocal University Program, Chonnam National University **2025**
Research Grant Recipient · KRW 3 million (approx. USD 2,000)

Learning Lab Program Scholarship,
Korea Institute of Human Resources Development in Science and Technology **2024**
Scholarship Recipient · KRW 4 million (approx. USD 2,700)

Innovation Research Scholarship,
Chonnam National University **2021–2023**
Scholarship Recipient · Total award: KRW 3 million (approx. USD 2,000)

The 4th GS SHOP Content Leader Scholarship,
Korean Society for Journalism and Communication Studies and GS SHOP **2020**
Scholarship Recipient · KRW 2 million (approx. USD 1,300)

Selected Honors and Awards

Outstanding Award,
Competition for Social Value Enhancement Studies, Center for Social Value Enhancement Studies **2023**
Research project: Can Social Robots Reduce Loneliness among Older Adults?

Outstanding Award,
Competition for Business Strategies Incorporating Cultural Diversity, KOTRA **2015**
Project: Market Entry Strategies for Medical Devices in Japan's Elderly Care Sector

Research Methods and Technical Skills

Study Design

- Field deployments · Human-subject experiments · Ecological momentary assessment · Multi-wave panel and longitudinal studies · Repeated-measures designs · Agent-based simulation · LLM evaluation

Quantitative Analysis

- Multilevel and mixed-effects models · Moderation analysis · Longitudinal modeling · Network-based user clustering

Computational Tools

- Python · R

Teaching Appointments

Lecturer, Ansan, South Korea
School of Smart Convergence, Hanyang University ERICA **Mar 2026–Present**

- Teach "Digital Health Design", covering user-centered design for health technologies from needs assessment through prototyping and evaluation.

Prior Professional Experience

Manager, Naju, South Korea
AI & Digital Media Business TF, Korea Communications Agency **May 2018–Feb 2024**

- Managed national ICT R&D funding programs and conducted policy research on AI and digital media for government stakeholders.

Professional Service

External Reviewer,
ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human–Robot Interaction (HRI 2027) **2026**

External Reviewer,
***Design Works*, Korean Society of Design Science** **2026**

External Reviewer,
***Korean Journal of Broadcasting & Telecommunications Research*, Korean Association for Broadcasting & Telecommunication Studies** **2026**

Member,
Committee for Jeollanam-do's Investment-Funded Institutions **Jan 2023–Present**

- Review and evaluate performance of provincially funded research and public institutions.

Member,
Research Group for Future Strategic Industries in Sejong **May 2024–Aug 2024**

- Advised on emerging technology trends for national industrial strategy.

References

Chungmin Joo, Ph.D. truejoo77@daum.net
Professor, Chonnam National University · Doctoral Advisor

Hyeseung Yang, Ph.D. yanghs@jnu.ac.kr
Professor, Chonnam National University · Research Collaborator

Duk-Jo Kong, Ph.D. dukjokong@gist.ac.kr
Assistant Professor, Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology · Principal Investigator